

The 5-Minute Executive Report Test

Five questions to see whether your report helps leadership focus on what matters.

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Choose one report that regularly goes to leadership.

It can be a monthly management report, KPI package, board report, dashboard, or operating report. Do not redesign it or analyze every page. Just answer these five questions based on how the report is actually used.

1 Who actually uses this report?

Distribution is not the same as use.

Who receives it?

Who actively uses it in meetings or to make decisions?

2 What is this report supposed to help them understand or decide?

Try to answer in one or two sentences.

3 What KPIs or measures does the report contain?

List the recurring measures leadership is expected to pay attention to.

4 Which KPIs actually influence a discussion, question, action, or decision?

Think about the last few times the report was used.

5 If you removed half the KPIs tomorrow, which ones would leadership ask you to put back?

Those may be the measures doing the real work.



What Did You Notice?

This is not a score. It is a quick way to spot where a report may deserve a closer look.

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Compare your answers

AUDIENCE GAP

Are there people receiving the report who do not appear to use it?

PURPOSE GAP

Can you clearly state what the report helps leadership understand or decide?

ATTENTION GAP

How many KPIs from Question 3 also appeared in Questions 4 or 5?

If you could improve just one thing about this report, what would it be?

Do not change anything yet.

The purpose of this five-minute test is not to prove that your report is good or bad. It is to notice whether what you are producing matches how leadership actually uses it. If the answers surprised you, the report may deserve a closer look.

Want to go deeper?

The 30-Minute Test is a paid, self-guided assessment that takes the next step by examining how a report performs in an actual leadership meeting across five dimensions: Purpose, Trust, Focus, Context and Decision Readiness.

Interested in the 30-Minute Test or want to discuss your reporting?

Email support@boardviewanalytics.com

